

Norway

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Switzerland

Switzerland have become one of the most consistent national teams in Europe. They rarely arrive at major tournaments as favorites, but they almost always bring tactical discipline, experienced leadership and enough technical quality to make themselves difficult to beat.

Murat Yakin's team is built around structure, midfield control and tournament pragmatism. Granit Xhaka remains the central reference point, giving Switzerland passing rhythm, leadership and emotional intensity. Around him, the squad has enough depth to adapt between a back three, a back four and more conservative shapes depending on the opponent.

Switzerland's best World Cup finishes came in 1934, 1938 and 1954, when they reached the quarter-finals. In the modern era, they have become a regular tournament side, repeatedly qualifying and often reaching the knockout stage without quite breaking into the final rounds.

Recent Swiss World Cup campaigns have followed a familiar pattern: solid group-stage performances, disciplined defending and competitive knockout matches. Switzerland reached the Round of 16 in 2014, 2018 and 2022, but the quarter-final barrier remains a major target.

Argentina

Argentina arrive at the 2026 World Cup with a rare combination of status, pressure and continuity. They are not just another contender. They are the defending champions, the reference point for every rival trying to measure itself against the highest tournament standard. That gives Argentina authority, but it also increases the expectation around every group-stage performance.

The team built under Lionel Scaloni has become one of the most complete national sides in modern football. Argentina can control matches through midfield, defend narrow leads with discipline, press aggressively in selected moments and still rely on individual quality in decisive attacking situations. This mixture of structure and personality is the main reason Argentina should be treated as a serious title candidate again in 2026.

From a tournament-analysis perspective, Argentina's page is one of the most important team profiles on the site. Users searching for Argentina World Cup 2026 analysis usually want more than a short squad note. They want tactical context, fixture information, key player roles, group-stage expectations and a realistic prediction of how far Argentina can go.

Argentina are three-time World Cup winners, lifting the trophy in 1978, 1986 and 2022. Their 2022 triumph in Qatar ended a 36-year wait and placed Lionel Messi's generation alongside the most celebrated teams in Argentine football history. For a country where World Cup identity is deeply tied to national emotion, that victory changed the way this team is viewed.

Argentina's World Cup story is built on iconic players, dramatic matches and a strong connection between technical quality and competitive edge. Diego Maradona's 1986 team and Lionel Messi's 2022 side are different in style, but both represent the same national expectation: Argentina do not simply participate at a World Cup; they are judged by their ability to compete for the trophy.

England

England arrive at the 2026 World Cup with a squad strong enough to win the tournament, but also with a familiar question: can the Three Lions turn elite talent into a trophy? The team has reached major finals and semi-finals in recent cycles, yet the pressure to end the long wait for a second World Cup title remains enormous.

The appointment of Thomas Tuchel changes the tactical conversation. England still have the core of players who made them a consistent knockout-stage side, but Tuchel is expected to bring more detail in pressing, rest defense, midfield spacing and attacking structure. That matters because England's biggest issue has often been game control in decisive matches against elite opponents.

England's only World Cup triumph came in 1966, when they won the tournament on home soil. That title still defines the national team's historical standard and explains why every strong England generation is judged against the question of whether it can finally win another major trophy.

In the modern era, England have become a far more consistent tournament team. Semi-final and final appearances across recent major competitions have rebuilt belief, even though the final step has remained elusive. The squad no longer carries the same reputation for early exits, but it still has to prove it can win the defining match.

France

France arrive at the 2026 World Cup with a profile few national teams can match: recent tournament pedigree, world-class depth, elite athleticism and one of the most decisive attacking players in modern football. After winning the 2018 World Cup and reaching the 2022 final, Les Bleus remain a benchmark for every other contender.

The defining feature of France is not only star quality, but repeatability. Deschamps has built a national team that can adapt to different game states, defend deep if needed, attack quickly in transition and still dominate weaker opponents through talent and structure. That flexibility makes France dangerous across a long tournament.

France are two-time World Cup champions, winning the tournament in 1998 and 2018. The 1998 title established the modern identity of Les Bleus, while the 2018 triumph confirmed France as one of the defining international teams of the current era.

France reached the 2022 final and came within penalties of back-to-back World Cup titles. That run reinforced their status as a team built for major tournaments. Even when injuries or tactical problems appear, France usually find a way to remain competitive deep into the competition.

Spanien

Spain arrive at the 2026 World Cup with a squad that looks very different from the team that dominated international football between 2008 and 2012. The core idea is still familiar: technical control, intelligent positioning and midfield superiority. The difference is that this Spain side has more pace, width and direct one-on-one threat than many previous versions of La Roja.

Luis de la Fuente has built a team that can control possession without becoming predictable. Rodri gives Spain stability and rhythm, Pedri provides creativity between lines, while Lamine Yamal and Nico Williams add the acceleration and unpredictability that Spain often lacked in previous World Cup cycles.

Spain won their first and only FIFA World Cup in 2010, completing the central chapter of one of the greatest international football eras ever. That team combined Xavi, Andres Iniesta, Sergio Busquets, David Villa, Iker Casillas and a deep supporting cast that made possession football the global reference point.

Since that title, Spain's World Cup results have been mixed. They exited at the group stage in 2014, reached the Round of 16 in 2018 and again fell short of expectations in 2022. Those tournaments created a clear lesson: control alone is not enough if the team lacks penetration and finishing efficiency.

Belgium

Belgium arrive at the 2026 World Cup with a different type of pressure than in previous tournaments. For much of the last decade, the Red Devils were judged as a team that had to win because of their extraordinary generation of players. In 2026, the picture is more complex: Belgium remain talented, but the squad is also transitioning toward a new structure.

The central question is whether Belgium can combine remaining elite experience with younger energy. Kevin De Bruyne and Romelu Lukaku still represent the memory of Belgium's peak era, while players such as Jérémy Doku, Amadou Onana, Loïs Openda and Charles De Ketelaere give the team more speed, physicality and future-facing attacking options.

Belgium's World Cup history is marked by one major modern peak: the 2018 tournament in Russia. That team finished third after beating Brazil in the quarter-finals and England in the third-place match. It was Belgium's best World Cup finish and the high point of a generation that spent years near the top of international football.

The difficulty for Belgium has always been turning talent into a final. The Red Devils have had world-class players across multiple positions, but knockout football often exposes small structural weaknesses. The 2022 group-stage exit was a clear sign that the previous cycle had run out of momentum.

In 2026, Belgium are not simply trying to repeat the golden generation's peak. They are trying to build a new version of the national team while still using the experience of players who know what elite tournament football demands.

Morocco

Morocco arrive at the 2026 World Cup with a very different status from previous generations. Before 2022, they were respected as one of Africa's strongest national teams. After Qatar, they became a global reference point for defensive organization, tournament belief and African football ambition.

The Atlas Lions' semi-final run changed expectations permanently. Morocco are no longer simply a dangerous underdog; they are a team that major nations must prepare for seriously. The challenge in 2026 is proving that the 2022 run was not a one-off moment, but the start of a sustained elite cycle.

Morocco made World Cup history in 2022 by becoming the first African and Arab nation to reach the semi-finals. Their run included famous victories over Belgium, Spain and Portugal, and it gave the Atlas Lions one of the most iconic tournament stories of the modern era.

Morocco's World Cup history did not begin in 2022. In 1986, they became the first African nation to win a World Cup group, finishing ahead of England, Poland and Portugal before reaching the Round of 16. That campaign remains an important foundation in Moroccan football history.